

SEMINAR 1

History of AI

30.03.2026

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Outline of the course

- Lectures & book: exam material (both are important)
- Types of sessions:
 - Lectures
 - Lecture recap
 - Book recap & working on assignment (**this session**)
 - Assignment feedback
- Assignment bonus: [avg. of 4 best out of 6] > 6 → you can skip a designated question on the exam
- Exam = 100% of final grade
- Lectures, seminars and assignments aren't mandatory – but recommended!

Course schedule

week 14					week 17					week 21				
Mon 30 Mar	11:00 - 12:45	Lecture	History of AI (HC)	MF-FG1 (343/85T)	Mon 20 Apr	11:00 - 12:45	Lecture	History of AI (HC)	MF-FG1 (343/85T)	Mon 18 May	11:00 - 12:45	Lecture	History of AI (HC)	Theater2-NU-00C745 (279)
	13:30 - 15:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	NU-4A54 (24/12T)		13:30 - 15:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	NU-4A54 (24/12T)		13:30 - 15:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	NU-4A54 (24/12T)
	17:30 - 19:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	MF-A611 (36/18T)		17:30 - 19:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	MF-A611 (36/18T)		17:30 - 19:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	MF-A611 (36/18T)
Wed 1 Apr	13:30 - 14:15	Seminar	History of AI (WC) Groups via Canvas	NU-4B11 (24/12T) NU-4B17 (24/12T)	Wed 22 Apr	13:30 - 14:15	Seminar	History of AI (WC) Groups via Canvas	NU-4B11 (24/12T) NU-4B17 (24/12T)	week 22				
	14:30 - 15:15	Seminar	History of AI (WC) Groups via Canvas	NU-4B11 (24/12T) NU-4B17 (24/12T)		14:30 - 15:15	Seminar	History of AI (WC) Groups via Canvas	NU-4B11 (24/12T) NU-4B17 (24/12T)	Thu 28 May	15:30 - 17:45	Digital exam	History of AI (DT)	(T) IN-2B42 2B56 (DT84) (T) IN-2B43 2B55 (DT93) (T) IN-3B39 3B45 3B59 (DT60) (T) IN-3B44 3B50 3B52 (DT80)
week 15					week 19									
Wed 8 Apr	09:00 - 10:45	Lecture	History of AI (HC)	Theater2-NU-00C745 (279)	Wed 6 May	09:00 - 10:45	Lecture	History of AI (HC)	Theater2-NU-00C745 (279)		15:30 - 18:15	Digital exam - extra time	History of AI (DTX) Extra Time	(T) IN-3B44 3B50 3B52 (DT80)
	11:00 - 12:45	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	NU-2B11 (24/12T)		11:00 - 12:45	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	NU-2B11 (24/12T)	week 27				
	13:30 - 15:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	HG-05A16 (38/19T)		13:30 - 15:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	HG-05A16 (38/19T)			Thu 2 Jul	12:15 - 14:30	Digital resit
Fri 10 Apr	13:30 - 14:15	Seminar	History of AI (WC) Groups via Canvas	NU-5A59 (20/10T) NU-5A65 (20/10T)	Fri 8 May	13:30 - 14:15	Seminar	History of AI (WC) Groups via Canvas	NU-5A59 (20/10T) NU-5A65 (20/10T)	12:15 - 15:00	Digital exam - extra time	History of AI (DTX) Extra Time	(T) NU-1B05 (DT124)	
	14:30 - 15:15	Seminar	History of AI (WC) Groups via Canvas	NU-5A59 (20/10T) NU-5A65 (20/10T)		14:30 - 15:15	Seminar	History of AI (WC) Groups via Canvas	NU-5A59 (20/10T) NU-5A65 (20/10T)					
week 16					week 20									
Mon 13 Apr	11:00 - 12:45	Lecture	History of AI (HC)	MF-FG1 (343/85T)	Mon 11 May	11:00 - 12:45	Lecture	History of AI (HC)	MF-FG1 (343/85T)					
	13:30 - 15:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	NU-4A54 (24/12T)		13:30 - 15:15	Seminar group	History of AI (WG)	NU-4A54 (24/12T)					
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Getting to know each other

- Introduce yourself: name and a fun fact

Book presentations

- First part of each seminar; short recap, every week, around 20 min. per chapter (2 chapters/students per class)
- Choose your chapter:
https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/17o_bn65RNOMPVteT7thzOMuiA5LD4CmvR7XXST1RhCg/edit?usp=sharing
- **Everyone should present at least once** - please sign up!



Writing exercises

- Second part of each seminar, working through the assignment questions through the use of structured exercises: individually, in small groups, or all together.

PLENARY – we plan the essay as the group, everybody writes their version; group discussion/presentation

GROUPS – working in groups of 3-5 students, plan the essay, then everyone writes their version; group discussion/presentation.

INDIVIDUAL – Everyone writes the essay by themselves; group discussion + presentation

ACTIVE READING

Active reading

- What are strategies to read effectively?

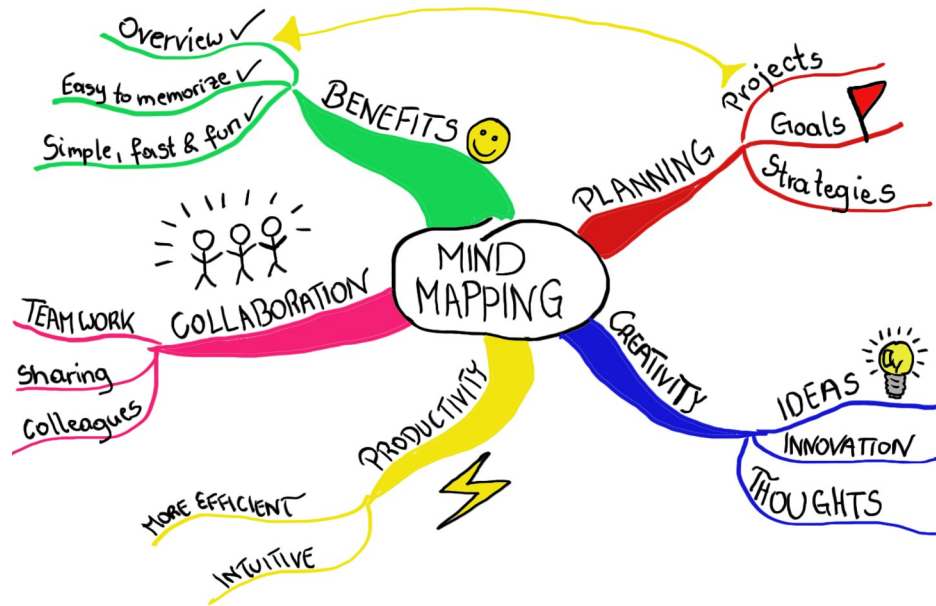
- Finding core sentences
- Finding examples in the text
- Writing down associations/questions that pop up



Making a summary/mind map

- Avoid passive strategies
 - Marking < writing down
 - Typing < writing by hand
 - Copying < paraphrasing
 - Just writing < mind mapping

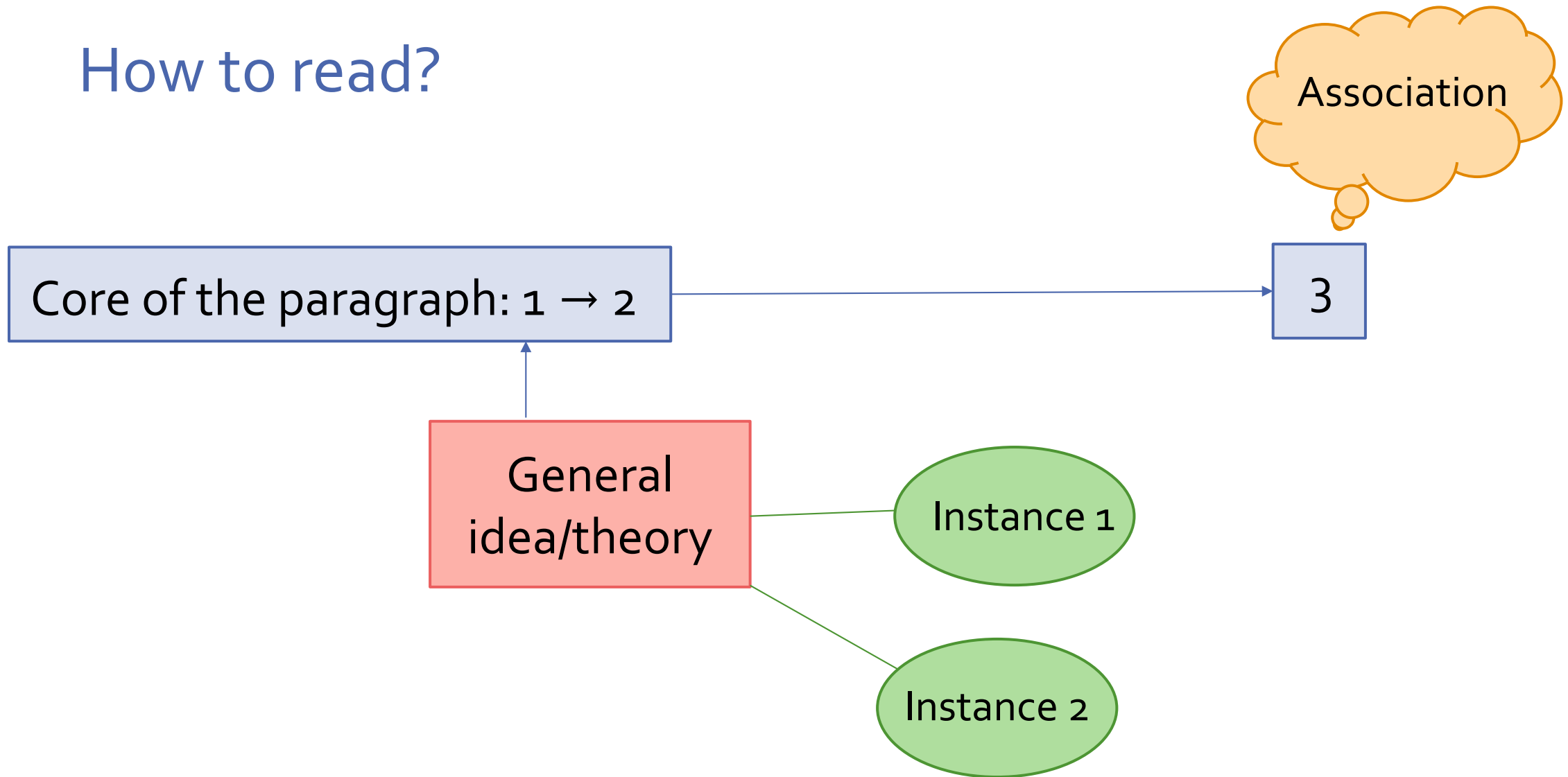
Organizing information



PART I : the scientific revolution

- "modern science" → usually ~ 17th C
 - but: did not emerge suddenly & completely (sudden transition → questionable)
 - but still important!
 - new philosophy on reality
 - new outlook on nature
 - new theories
 - sc. programme: science ≠ fixed truths but search → did emerge in 17th C.
- scientific revolution → MA: different universe
- ex.: astronomy well-advanced before 17th C and some 17th C practice based on superstition.
- ass. with pioneers:
- Copernicus
 - Kepler
 - Galileo
 - Newton

How to read?



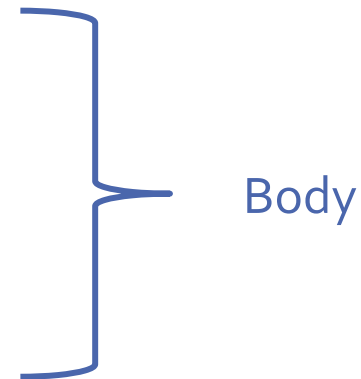
Writing essays: basic structure

- What is an essay?
 - Statement (thesis)/question → narrative (here, the “thesis” is defined by the exam question)
 - Structure: intro, body, conclusion
 - In this case: 200 words min.
- 
- Intro
 - Tell what the reader can expect in the following text
 - Perhaps one sentence summarizing your content
 - Maybe a question, anecdote or statistic
 - Body
 - The actual content
 - Conclusion
 - Summary, repeating of the question/statement if present
 - Maybe a follow-up question

Answering every part of the question

ENIAC (1946) is in the book picked as the starting point of a history of computing. At the same time, this starting point is discussed. Explain why this machine is an obvious starting point and mention an alternative - with arguments why it could count as an alternative, and why it was passed by.

- a) ENIAC is an obvious starting point because...
- b) An alternative starting point would be...
- c) It counts as an alternative because...
- d) It was passed by because...



WRITING EXERCISES

Assignment 1.1: Histories of computing

The "prehistory" of computing cannot be understood as one history. Several histories, sometimes (but hardly) intersecting, have to be taken into account to understand where the computer actually had its origins. Explain this statement.

PLENARY:

- Discuss as a group, plan the essay together.
- Individually write the essay.
- Present answers to the class, discuss.

Assignment 1.2: History of AI

In the lecture, it was suggested that history of AI is older than history of computing. Explain the line of thought.

PLENARY:

- Discuss as a group, plan the essay together.
- Individually write the essay.
- Present answers to the class, discuss.

Assignment 1.3: Artificial language

During the early 20th century various artificial languages were developed, all from rather different perspectives. Give two examples and explain their relevance in the history of AI.

GROUPS

- Form groups of 3-5 people. In your group, write an essay plan – main arguments, narratives, ideas, supporting examples...
- Individually, write your essay, basing it on your group's plan.
- Present plans and essays to the class, discuss.

Assignment 1.4: Digital culture

During the course the notion of digital culture was introduced as a defining characteristic of modern culture. Give an example from your own profession or experience where digital culture is fitting to describe the change in an existing habit. Explain how (or in what way) computer technology actually changed the situation. Discuss the positive and negative implications of this change.

INDIVIDUAL

- Plan the essay by yourself. Make sure to answer all parts of the question, support your ideas with examples and argumentation.
- Write the essay, basing it on your plan.
- Present essays to the class, discuss.

QUESTIONS?

See you next week!